Direct Green Card for Nurses: Schedule A Guide

How U.S. Hospitals Sponsor Permanent Residency in 12-18 Months

- Registered Nurses & Physical Therapists bypass the entire PERM labor market test.
- Classified by the U.S. Department of Labor under 20 CFR § 656.5 (Schedule A, Group I).
- Direct EB-3 Immigrant Visa petition for the clinician AND immediate family.
- Nationwide shortage across all 50 states drives hospital-sponsored legal fees.

KEY TAKEAWAY / ACTION:

Immediate permanent resident status—not a temporary guest worker visa.

Why Schedule A Bypasses the PERM Market Test

Federal Recognition of Pre-Certified Healthcare Shortages

- **Standard EB-3:**
  Employers must spend 12-18 months advertising to prove no U.S. worker is available before filing an immigrant petition.

- **Schedule A Exemption:**
  U.S. Department of Labor has already pre-certified that there are insufficient U.S. nurses to meet healthcare needs.

- **Speed Advantage:**
  File Form I-140 directly with USCIS from day one.

KEY TAKEAWAY / ACTION:

Saves 1 to 2 years compared to standard corporate Green Card tracks.

The 4 Core Eligibility Milestones

What Every International Nurse Must Secure Before Filing

- **1. Academic Credential:**
  BSc Nursing (or equivalent recognized diploma).
- **2. NCLEX-RN:**
  Passing score on the official National Council Licensure Examination.
- **3. English Proficiency:**
  Academic IELTS (Overall 6.5, Speaking 7.0) or TOEFL iBT.
- **4. VisaScreen Certificate:**
  Comprehensive credential evaluation issued by CGFNS.

KEY TAKEAWAY / ACTION:

Once you pass NCLEX-RN, U.S. healthcare systems will sponsor your petition.

What U.S. Hospital Sponsors Typically Cover

Standard Enterprise Relocation & Legal Assistance Packages

- **Legal & Filing Fees:**
  Form I-140 filing fees and immigration attorney costs covered.
- **Premium Processing:**
  Often sponsored to receive 15-day USCIS adjudication.
- **Relocation Stipends:**
  Flights, initial housing allowance, and state licensing support.
- **Mandated Wages:**
  Prevailing wages typically range from $72,000 to $125,000+ USD.

KEY TAKEAWAY / ACTION:

Zero placement or recruitment fees can legally be charged to nurses.

State-by-State Healthcare Compensation

Median RN Wages Across Top Sponsoring Regions (2026 DOL Data)

- **California:**
  $115,000 – $145,000 USD (Mandated nurse-to-patient ratios).
- **Texas:**
  $78,000 – $98,000 USD (0% State income tax, booming medical centers).
- **New York:**
  $88,000 – $112,000 USD (Major academic hospital networks).
- **Florida:**
  $74,000 – $92,000 USD (High retirement demographic demand).

KEY TAKEAWAY / ACTION:

Factor in overtime, night differentials, and hospital retirement match.

Your Step-by-Step Healthcare Roadmap

From Home Country Preparation to First Hospital Shift

- **Phase 1:**
  Complete CGFNS CES credential evaluation & apply for NCLEX ATT.
- **Phase 2:**
  Pass NCLEX-RN and achieve target IELTS/TOEFL scores.
- **Phase 3:**
  Connect with direct hospital sponsors & secure prevailing wage offer.
- **Phase 4:**
  File Form I-140, attend embassy consular interview, and relocate.

KEY TAKEAWAY / ACTION:

Browse verified hospital sponsors: uscareersolutions.online/healthcare